residence and/or nationality, location or incorporation of the individual or entity concerned to seek additional information.' [4] Using this clause, the Chinese suggested that the 'relevant parties' have further communication. In this case, 'relevant parties' did not mean India and China, but India and Pakistan. This was not merely a clever use of procedure, but a tactic to claim that the listing of Masood Azhar was not a bilateral problem between India and China. Meanwhile, in their carefully worded public pronouncements, the Chinese always showed a 'full' understanding of Indian concerns, and repeated the homily about terrorism being a threat to the entire world. China, they averred, opposed all forms of terrorism and supported international efforts to end it. China pleaded that all it was attempting to do by placing the 'hold' on India's proposal was to fulfil the letter and spirit of the UN Security Council resolutions relating to the listing of entities and individuals associated with Al-Qaida. By claiming that the 'hold' was, therefore, 'technical' in nature, they sought to remove any political imputation. To the outsider, the Chinese explanation sounded reasonable.

This Chinese narrative was also helpful to them in managing public opinion in India and keeping anti-China sentiment in check. So far as their suggestion of India talking to Pakistan went, the Chinese were very well aware that it would make no headway because Pakistan denied any knowledge of the whereabouts of Masood Azhar. China hoped to utilize the time thus gained to either create doubts in the minds of some committee members so that it was no longer alone in its opposition to the listing, or to dilute the Indian asks, or both. Informal feelers were put out in New Delhi suggesting that China might reconsider if India consented to remove all direct references to the Pakistan government's involvement in